One-page checklist for exam week

Understand it

In the last week, do not learn anything new. Review the patterns you already know and make them automatic.

Your aim on exam day is accuracy and calm. A simple sentence that is correct is better than a complex one that is wrong.

The rules

- Task 2: introduction (paraphrase + position), 2 body paragraphs (point, reason, example), conclusion (restate). At least 250 words.
- Task 1: paraphrase + overview + 2 detail paragraphs. At least 150 words. Compare, do not list.
- Before submitting: tense, agreement, articles, spelling, punctuation, linking words, word count.
- Speaking: answer, reason, example. Do not memorize. If you make a mistake, correct it calmly and keep going.

All the words and forms you need

Task 2 shape	introduction (paraphrase + position) · body 1 · body 2 · conclusion
Task 1 shape	paraphrase · overview · detail 1 · detail 2
Speaking pattern	answer · reason · example · (feeling)
Final check list	tense · agreement · articles · plurals · spelling · punctuation · word count

Where you use it

Writing: Use this page the evening before, then stop studying.

Speaking: Smile, speak slowly, and extend every answer by one sentence.

Reading: Read the question first, then the text.

More examples

- In my view, the advantages of online learning outweigh the disadvantages.
- Overall, car ownership rose while bus use fell.
- I'd say I prefer the countryside, mainly because it is quieter. For example, ...
- All things considered, governments should invest more in public transport.
- The most noticeable trend is the steady rise in online sales.
- To be honest, I've never thought about that, but I suppose ...

Common mistakes

Wrong	Right
✗ Rewriting the question word for word.	✓ Paraphrase the question in your own words.
✗ Listing every number in Task 1.	✓ Select and compare the key figures.
✗ Giving one-word answers in Speaking.	✓ Answer + reason + example.

Speaking practice: answer using this grammar

1. Answer three Part 1 questions about your home in the full pattern.
2. Talk for 2 minutes about a skill you want to learn.
3. What changes would make your city better?
4. Do you think technology helps us learn?
5. Describe your perfect weekend.

Writing practice

Plan (do not write) two Task 2 essays in 5 minutes each.

Practice

1. Paraphrase: Some people think children should start school early.

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2. What goes in a Task 1 overview?

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3. How long should Task 2 be?

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4. How many body paragraphs?

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5. What do you do in Part 1 after the answer?

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6. What do you do after a mistake in Speaking?

Answers

1. It is believed by some that children ought to begin school at a young age.
2. The main trends or the main differences, without figures.
3. At least 250 words.
4. Usually two (or three).
5. Give a reason and an example.
6. Correct it calmly and continue.